

Malte H. Hinrichs

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Education

PhD in Economics	10/2023–present
Queen's University Belfast, UK	
Affiliated with: Centre for Economics, Policy and History (CEPH)	
Dissertation Title: <i>Water, Wheels, and the Wealth of Nations: Geography and Path Dependence in European Industrialization</i>	
Submission: 27/08/2026 · Viva: 21/10/2026	
MSc Economics	09/2020–09/2022
University of Mannheim, Germany	
Thesis: <i>Engines of Growth? The Role of the Steam Engine for Long-Run Economic Development in Germany</i>	
Visiting Student	02/2021–06/2021
NHH Norwegian School of Economics, Norway	
BSc Economics	09/2017–08/2020
University of Mannheim, Germany	
Thesis: <i>The Long-Term Effects of Colonialism on Income Inequality</i>	
Visiting Student	08/2019–12/2019
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Hong Kong	

Publications

“Water mills and human capital accumulation in industrialising Prussia”	07/2026
<i>Explorations in Economic History</i> , 101(1): 101767.	
Article: doi:10.1016/j.eeh.2026.101767	
Replication Package: doi:10.17632/pvnh7g4b39.2	

Job Market Paper

“Leapfrogging or path dependence? Water mills and long-run growth in the Scottish Industrial Revolution”
Latest draft available on my website .

Abstract: Does technological change favour agile entrants or adaptable incumbents? I examine this using Scotland's industrialisation, testing whether steam power allowed new locations to “leapfrog” centres of water power. Using a newly constructed dataset linking over 1,200 pre-industrial mills to parish-level outcomes, and an instrumental variable strategy based on geographic endowments, I reject the leapfrogging hypothesis. An additional mill in 1755 caused 8% higher long-run population growth (driven by migration), with effects intensifying precisely when steam power became abundant. Micro-evidence reveals that hydraulically advantaged mill sites largely survived, transitioned to industrial production and avoided obsolescence by integrating steam power as a complementary technology. The findings demonstrate that proto-industrial water power provided the critical infrastructure and human capital for the steam age, challenging the view that coal endowments alone determined the industrial map.

Working Papers

“Market access without roads: First-nature geography and European city growth, 700–1800”
Draft available upon request.

Teaching Experience

Queen’s University Belfast

Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (course design, tutorials)	09/2025–01/2026
Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, exam supervision, marking)	09/2024–01/2025

University of Mannheim

Macroeconomics A, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, student mentoring)	02/2020–08/2020
Statistics II, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, student mentoring)	09/2019–12/2019
Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, exam organisation)	09/2018–12/2018

Honours and Awards

Winner, Three Minute Thesis (3MT®) Competition, Queen’s University Belfast	04/2026
New Researcher Prize, Economic History Society	04/2026
Graduated in top 20% of MSc Economics cohort, University of Mannheim	09/2022
Graduated in top 10% of BSc Economics cohort, University of Mannheim	08/2020
Dean’s List, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology	12/2019

Research Grants and Funding

Santander Career Support Award	05/2026
Economic History Society New Researcher Conference Bursary	01/2026
EHES Conference Travel and Accommodation Grant	07/2025
Economic History Society Young Scholar Conference Bursary	01/2025
CEPH Studentship, Irish Higher Education Authority, full funding for PhD studies	10/2023
PROMOS Scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service, full funding for HKUST	06/2019

Professional Memberships

Economic History Society (UK)
European Historical Economics Society
Irish Economic Association

Academic Presentations

Invited Talks

Graduate Seminar in Economic and Social History, University of Oxford	05/2026
Economic History Seminar, University of Hohenheim	03/2026
Department of Economics Seminar Series, Heriot-Watt University Edinburgh	01/2026

Centre for Economic History Seminar Series , Queen's University Belfast	04/2024
Conference and Workshop Presentations	
CEPH PhD Workshop , Queen's University Belfast	05/2026
Queen's Postgraduate Research Conference , Queen's University Belfast	05/2026
Economic History Society Conference , London School of Economics	04/2026
Irish Postgraduate and Early Career Economics Workshop , Maynooth University	01/2026
European Historical Economics Society Conference , University of Hohenheim	09/2025
CEPH Workshop in Quantitative Economic History , Queen's University Belfast	06/2025
Queen's Postgraduate Research Conference , Queen's University Belfast	06/2025
Economic History Society Conference , University of Strathclyde	04/2025
Centre for Economic History PhD Discussion Group , Queen's University Belfast	02/2025
Centre for Economic History PhD Discussion Group , Queen's University Belfast	03/2024

Professional Development

Graduate Teaching Assistant Workshop , The Economics Network	01/2025
Economic History Society Residential Training , University of Warwick	11/2024
Financial, Economic and Business History Summer School , University of Groningen	06/2024
Workshop for Teaching Assistants , University of Mannheim	09/2018

Public Engagement

<i>'Die Kraft des Wassers: Deutschlands vergessene Industrialisierung'</i> Featured Interview, GEO Magazine (Germany)	08/2026
<i>'Chatting GPT: What does history tell us about the future of AI?'</i> Invited Speaker, ESRC Festival of Social Science	10/2025

Industry Experience

KPMG AG Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft Junior Consultant, Global Transfer Pricing (Mannheim, Germany)	04/2023–09/2023
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Technical Skills

Econometric & Spatial Methods: Causal Inference (IV/2SLS, DiD, Panel/FE), Spatial Econometrics, GIS & Cost-Surface Analysis, Gravity Modelling
Software & Programming: R (<code>sf</code> , <code>terra</code>), Python, Stata, Matlab, QGIS, Git, Quarto, LaTeX
Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), Latin (reading)

References

Chris Colvin (PhD Supervisor)
Queen's University Belfast
chris.colvin@qub.ac.uk · [Website](#)

Alan Fernihough (PhD Supervisor)
Queen's University Belfast
a.fernihough@qub.ac.uk · [Website](#)

Alexander Donges (MSc & BSc Advisor)
University of Mannheim
donges@uni-mannheim.de · [Website](#)

John Turner (CEPH Director)
Queen's University Belfast
j.turner@qub.ac.uk · [Website](#)

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